of a Sino-Indian agreement that included the five principles of peaceful coexistence (or Panchsheel).

Did US military aid to Pakistan cause Delhi to seek a peace agreement with Beijing? Allen believed it did.[98] And Indian foreign secretary R. K. Nehru did argue for "nonaggression pacts with the Soviet and Chinese" governments as one of the ways to maintain the balance with Pakistan.[99] However, while the announcement of American aid to Pakistan might have contributed, India's desire to deepen its relations with China had preceded it. In March 1953, Burmese prime minister U Nu had first suggested that Burma, China, and India sign a fifty-year friendship and nonaggression agreement. Nehru had been unsure of the Chinese reaction given Beijing's adverse response to the Indian resolution on Korea at the UN in late 1952 and the resultant "coolness" toward India. Nonetheless, Nehru had welcomed the idea, but only if it was not "anti" any country. He also thought the duration too long, recommending instead a decade-long agreement with the possibility of renewal. He had suggested that rather than a trilateral agreement, the countries aim for bilateral ones. Nehru had wanted to be careful, telling the Indian ambassador in Beijing that any such agreements would have a powerful impact, especially on the US. Moreover, Beijing should not think Delhi wanted this more—China "did not respect those who show weakness," so India should be "both friendly and firm."[100]

From Nehru's perspective, continuing global and regional tension in fall 1953, despite Stalin's death and the end of the Korean War, had made it even more important for India to seek peace with China. But, thanks to India's NNRC role, Sino-Indian relations were not "not quite happy," as the Indian embassy in Beijing put it.[101] Therefore, Nehru had sought to avoid steps that China would see as unfriendly.[102] Subsequently, he had moved to settle issues that could cause tension between the two countries, announcing in September 1953 that his government had reached out to Beijing seeking talks.[103]

China and India began discussing the status of Tibet at the end of December 1953. In March 1954, Pillai told Allen to expect "some kind of statement of mutual desire … to maintain peace between [the] two countries" if the negotiations were successful.[104] What emerged was the Sino-Indian agreement, signed in April 1954, through which India implicitly recognized Chinese sovereignty over Tibet. Explicitly, it laid out